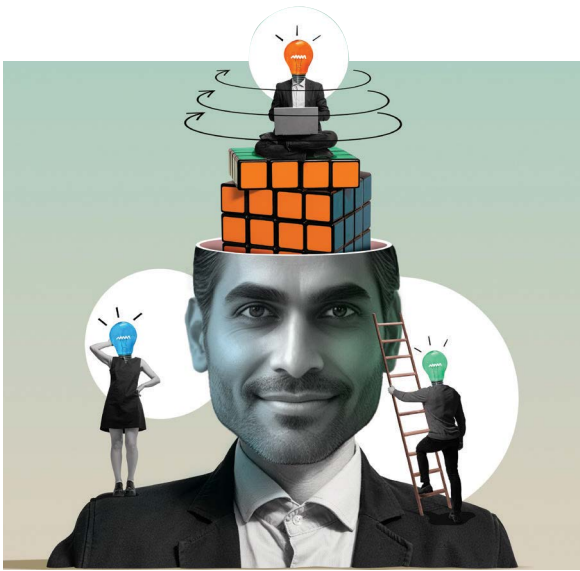




CHALLENGES GALORE

- The PMKVY has come under scrutiny for shortfall in enrolments, low placements
- There are questions over quality of training and poor wages
- There is also a disconnect between industry and schemes on course requirements and design
- Besides, there is a need to better incorporate vocational training and skilling in secondary education
- More awareness is needed amongst students on vocational training for jobs as an alternate to traditional degree courses

dress this, the government recently notified changes in the Apprentices Rules, 1992. This is expected to increase stipends.

Sharma of TeamLease Degree Apprenticeship notes that stipends have risen in recent years, with market dynamics driving competitiveness. “Employers offering attractive stipends along with educational opportunities experiencesignificantlylowerattrition. Wheresuch measures are absent, attrition remains a challenge,” he says.

Both Mehrotra and Krishna say there should be greater industry participation and it should be a demand-oriented outlook rather than the current supply-driven approach.

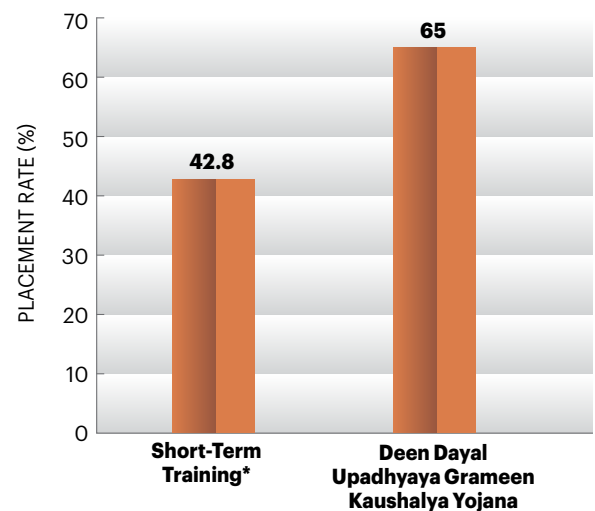
That said, there are areas, especially emerging

skills, where there is high demand and considerable opportunities. Yogesh Kumar, Director and Founder of JITM Skills, NSDC’s largest training partner that runs as many as 46 PM Kaushal Vikas Kendras apart from other skilling initiatives, says in several skills such as those related to artificial intelligence (AI), Internet of Things (IoT), social media and digital marketing and healthcare, there is a lot of demand and placements are good. Starting salaries can be in the range of ₹12,000–20,000 per month. According to him, three to six-month courses are often adequate. “India is running against time. We do not need a one-year or a three-year training degree for teaching skills for elder or disability care, where there is huge demand.” Krishna says there is need for a better mechanism to assess demand. “We need to tie up with industries and skill according to their current and future requirements. We also need to increase the vocationalisation of secondary education, making it a part of the curricula.”

India also needs to focus on training and skilling youth based on the demands of Industry 4.0, which includes AI, he says, adding that this will help attract investments from manufacturing companies that require a pool of trained and employable youth.

THE JOBS DEFICIT

- Placements after various skilling programmes are low
- PMKVY 4.0 has been delinked from placement



* FOR CERTIFIED CANDIDATES TILL PMKVY 3.0

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